RAFAEL MORETTI-KLEIN

Senior Backend Engineer | Python, Go

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 21 years of experience building large-scale systems in Python, Go and C++. Designed and wrote most of a Go entitlement service handling 120k requests per second at peak, and helped improve a playback API's availability from 99.5% to 99.95%. Experienced with PostgreSQL, event-driven systems, Kubernetes and production observability.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering, Platform | Streamhaus GmbH, Munich | 2019–August 2026

- Led a five-team platform organisation of 45 engineers responsible for identity, playback API, billing integration and developer platform.
- Drove migration of a Python 2 monolith to approximately 60 Python and Go services on GKE; playback API availability improved from 99.5% to 99.95%.
- Built an internal Python cost dashboard using BigQuery billing data; rightsizing and committed use discounts reduced cloud spend by 31% (EUR 4.2M per year).
- Introduced an RFC process, architecture review board and on-call guidelines adopted company-wide.

Principal Engineer | Streamhaus GmbH | 2015–2019

- Designed and wrote most of the Go entitlement service for subscriptions, regions and devices; handled 120k requests per second at peak with p99 latency under 15 ms.
- Served as technical lead for the playback API, using Python, Cassandra and Redis.
- Co-authored the company's service template and Python style guide.

Senior Software Engineer | Nordfels Telematik AG, Stuttgart | 2010–2015

- Built backend services for fleet telematics, ingesting GPS data from 300k vehicles using C++, Python, PostgreSQL/PostGIS and RabbitMQ.
- Led a team of six developers on the route-history product.

Software Engineer | Dataquelle Systems GmbH, Karlsruhe | 2005–2010

- Developed C++ and Python for industrial data acquisition software on Linux and embedded x86.
- Built a Python test harness used by QA for eight years.

SELECTED OPEN-SOURCE WORK

Maintainer of a Python retry library | 2012–2018

- Maintained a Python retry library with approximately 1.5k GitHub stars; handed over maintenance in 2018.
- Technologies: Python, pytest, tox.

EDUCATION

Dipl.-Inf. (equivalent to MSc) in Computer Science | Rhine Valley University | 2005

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, C++ (earlier experience)
Python: Django, Flask, FastAPI, Tornado, asyncio
Databases and messaging: PostgreSQL, PostGIS, Cassandra, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ

Cloud and infrastructure: GCP (GKE, Pub/Sub, BigQuery), AWS (EC2, S3), Kubernetes, Terraform
APIs and observability: gRPC, Protobuf, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry
Engineering: Distributed systems design, API design, architecture reviews, automated testing (pytest, tox)

LANGUAGES

German (native), Italian (native), English (fluent)

PUBLICATIONS & TALKS

“Running Python at 100k rps” — conference talk, 2018
“Cost is a feature” — internal platform engineering summit keynote, 2023